environment since nurses are patient-facing.

3. Methodical

Nurses play a lot of different roles throughout a shift. Many of them fill out paperwork, take notes for medical records, and provide patient care. Only a methodical person could fill out insurance forms while talking with a patient. It is a rewarding job, but it is tough. If nurses do not have a methodical nature, he or she may need to develop some multi-tasking and organizational habits.

4. Optimistic

Nurses who have optimistic dispositions can set the proper mood for healing. It's hard for patients to keep their spirits up. It is even harder when their nurse has a negative perspective.

5. Patience

The average patient will actively participate in behaviors that worsen his or her condition. It's estimated that 60 percent of patients do not follow their doctor's orders when taking prescription medications. It takes a lot of patience to deal with people who either will not or cannot follow the basic instructions that could save their lives. Nurses who get frustrated easily will end their shifts with plenty of tension, headaches. Of course, nurses also need extreme patience when filling out endless streams of insurance documents and medical records.

6. Empathetic

Nurses see people in some of their worst states. Over the time, nurses can get desensitized to the disturbing things they have seen. A nurse who feels empathy for other people, becomes more in-tune with their patients and can provide better care. Empathy helps nurses to communicate with patients and better understand what they are going through. It is, perhaps, the most essential personality trait of a successful nurse.

STUDENT'S ACTIVITY

The "Empty Your Pockets" Exercise to know the personality

This exercise is simple, but very effective as a way for students to get to know each other as well as learn about the personal meaning of the things we carry with us everyday.

Break the class down into small groups. The students take turns emptying their pockets (or pocketbooks, backpacks, etc.) to show their group what they are carrying with them.

No one is required to show anything that they would prefer NOT to show.

The person and the group then discuss what the objects say about the person. Does it reveal something about one's personality and lifestyle? Is there any one object that stands out as a reflection of some aspect of that person?

Sometimes what is MISSING also says something about the person.

Learning psychology (study of behavior) will help us to understand the factors affecting our behavior and also how to

Nursing-voc_Unit 03.indd 77 22-02-2019 4.44.18 PM